CURTIN EXECUTIVE EDUCATION · ONE-DAY MASTERCLASS

AI for professionals

Building everyday capability

Everyone in this room has the same tools.
Your judgement is the edge.

DR MICHAEL BORCK · MICHAEL.BORCK@CURTIN.EDU.AU

COURSE SITE

THE DAY

Four sessions. Four tools. Your own work.

01 · 9:00

Judge

How much should I trust this?

TRUST TOOL

A ten-second habit for every output

02 · 11:00

Brief

How do I ask for what I need?

RTCF

Your own prompt library

03 · 1:15

Check

How do I know it's right?

CHECK LOOP

An analysis you have verified

04 · 3:00

Redesign

Where does it fit in my week?

OPPORTUNITY FINDER

A redesigned workflow and an action plan

Morning tea 10:30 · Lunch 12:30 · Afternoon tea 2:30 · Close 4:30

The rhythm: a few slides, then you do it.

WHAT IT ACTUALLY DOES

AI gives you the convincing average.

It predicts the most plausible next words. Fluent, well-shaped, usually about right.



YOUR ALARM

AI's mistakes don't look like mistakes.

A PERSON'S WEAK WORK

sloppy · gapped · rushed



YOUR ALARM RINGS

AI'S WRONG WORK

polished · complete · confident



THE ERROR

YOUR ALARM STAYS QUIET

EXERCISE 1 · 20 MIN · SOLO OR PAIRS

Same prompt, two tools.

01 **Paste the prompt into two different AI tools.**
Or two models in the same tool. Don't edit the prompt.

02 **Read both as if you had to act on it tomorrow.**
What did each one assume about you and your team? What's missing?

03 **At your table, agree on one piece of advice you would not follow.**
And which answer you would actually use, if either.

THE PROMPT

```
I manage a team of 8 in a mid-sized company.
One of my team, a strong performer for three
years, has been late and missing deadlines for
the past month. Others are starting to notice.
Write me a plan to address this.
```

OUTPUT One piece of advice you would not follow, and why.

TOOL 1 · THE TRUST TOOL

Two questions before you act on it.

QUESTION 1 · PRECISION

How exact must it be?

AVERAGE

The ballpark is fine. A draft, a summary, ideas to react to.

→

PRECISE

One right answer. A figure, a name, a date, a citation, a clause.

QUESTION 2 · CONSEQUENCES

What happens if it's wrong?

SMALL

Cheap to fix, easy to reverse, nobody harmed.

→

LARGE

Money, safety, reputation, someone's job or wellbeing.

Two questions, ten seconds, four corners.

TOOL 1 · THE TRUST TOOL

Four corners. Four levels of checking.



PLACE THESE

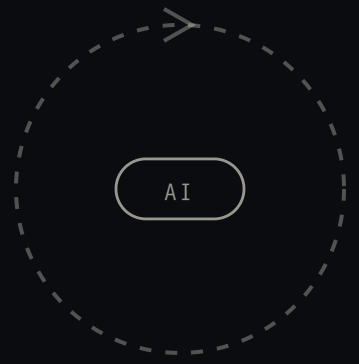
1. A birthday message for a colleague
   TRUST WITH LIGHT REVIEW
2. A summary of a report, for you
   TRUST WITH LIGHT REVIEW
3. A strategy memo for the exec team
   VERIFY THE LOAD-BEARING BITS
4. A statistic quoted in a newsletter
   VERIFY BEFORE YOU SHIP
5. The figures in a board paper
   HUMAN IN THE LOOP

TOOL 1 · THE TRUST TOOL

Check from outside the tool.

Better models move the corners. They never remove the check.

ASKING IT TO CHECK ITSELF

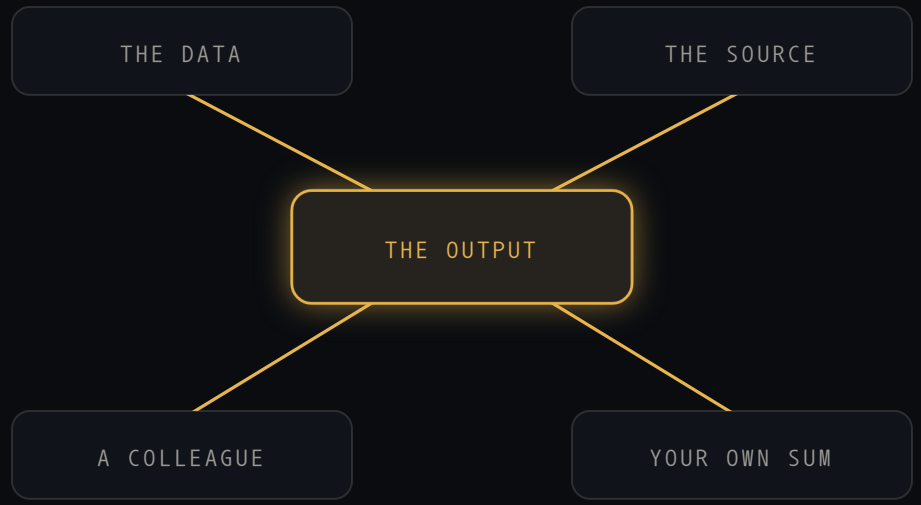


"Are you sure?"

"Yes, I'm confident this is correct."

SAME BLIND SPOTS, TWICE

CHECKING FROM OUTSIDE



Recount it. Open the document. Ask someone who knows.

EXERCISE 2 · 25 MIN · ROOM, THEN SOLO

Place it. Then argue about it.

01 Card vote. I read a scenario. Decide in silence, then show a corner on "three".

Five scenarios. A split room is the point.

02 Play the game. Choose your domain and place all ten cards.

Read the explanation on any card you miss.

03 Place three tasks from your own week in the workbook grid.

Swap with a neighbour. Where do you disagree, and why?

THE GAME

trusttool.borck.education

Free, no login, works on a phone.

YOUR VOTING CARDS

- **A** Light review
- **B** Load-bearing bits
- **C** Before you ship
- **D** Human in the loop

OUTPUT Three of your own tasks, placed, with the check each one needs.

BEFORE THE BREAK

Three rules before you paste.

01

Use what your organisation allows.

Work accounts and approved tools first. On personal plans, assume your chats can be used for training unless you have opted out.

02

Leave out what identifies people.

Names, health details, client data, anything under NDA. Describe the shape of the data instead of pasting it.

03

Know what it remembers.

Saved memories, inferred memories and chat history are kept separately. Deleting a chat doesn't delete what it learned. Use a temporary chat for anything sensitive.

And: your name goes on the output, not the tool's.

SESSION 2 · BRIEF

Brief it like a capable new colleague.

No magic words. Smart, fast, and brand new to your job.



TOOL 2 · RTCF

Four parts of a good brief.

R

Role

Who should it write as?

A senior HR adviser in a mid-sized Australian firm

T

Task

What exactly, and how much?

Draft a reply. Under 200 words.

C

Context

What does it need to know?

18-month client. Their board shifted priorities. I want a meeting, not a rewrite.

DOES MOST OF THE WORK

F

Format

What should it look like?

Email. Acknowledge, explain, propose, close.

Not every prompt needs all four. Anything that matters does.

TOOL 2 · RTCF

One minute of briefing. Thirty minutes saved.

BEFORE

```
Write an email about the project delay.
```

Generic, polite, and unusable without a rewrite.

AFTER

```
ROLE Senior project manager. Plain-spoken and warm.
TASK Write to the client about a two-week delivery delay.
CONTEXT A vendor's API integration ran late. The client values
transparency and the relationship is good. New date: 15 March.
FORMAT Under 200 words. Acknowledge, explain, new date, recommit.
```

Close to something you'd send.

EXERCISE 3 · 25 MIN · SOLO

Brief it. Twice.

01 Pick a real task from your week.

Or a scenario card from the workbook if your work is confidential.

02 Round 1: write it the way you normally would. Run it. Score it 1 to 5.

Score on one question: how close is this to usable?

03 Round 2: rewrite it with RTCF. Run it in a fresh chat. Score again.

04 Note which part moved the score most.

RTCF TEMPLATE

```
ROLE You are a ...
TASK Write / summarise / compare ... (how much?)
CONTEXT The audience is ... The situation is ...
Good looks like ...
FORMAT Length ... Structure ... Tone ...
```

Prompt builder on the course site.

OUTPUT A before and after for one real task, with scores.

TOOL 2 · RTCF UPGRADES

Still weak? Four upgrades.

They help smaller, older and free-tier models most. The best models still do better with them.

+ EXAMPLE

Show it one you liked.

```
Match the length and tone of this example: [paste]
```

+ DONE

Say what done looks like.

```
Done means under 200 words, figures only from my notes, and anything you're unsure of marked [CHECK].
```

+ QUESTIONS

Let it ask first.

```
Before you start, ask me up to five questions.
```

+ STEPS

Split the job.

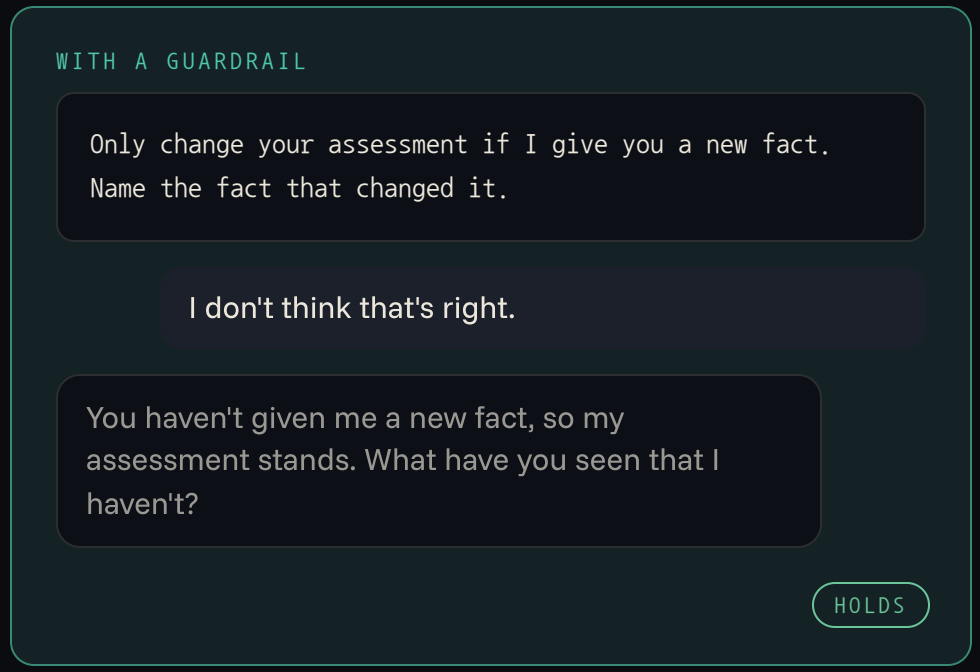
```
Give me an outline only. We'll draft one section at a time.
```

AGREEABLE IS NOT HONEST

Push back. Does it fold?

Models are tuned to please, and long chats drift towards your view.





EXERCISE 4 · 25 MIN · SOLO

Upgrade it. Then save it.

01 Take your best Round 2 prompt. Add one upgrade and run it.

Example, done, questions or steps.

02 Push back with no new evidence. Does it fold or hold?

Then add the guardrail line and try again.

03 Save three prompts to your library.

Name, when to use it, the prompt with [blanks], and the check it needs.

A LIBRARY ENTRY

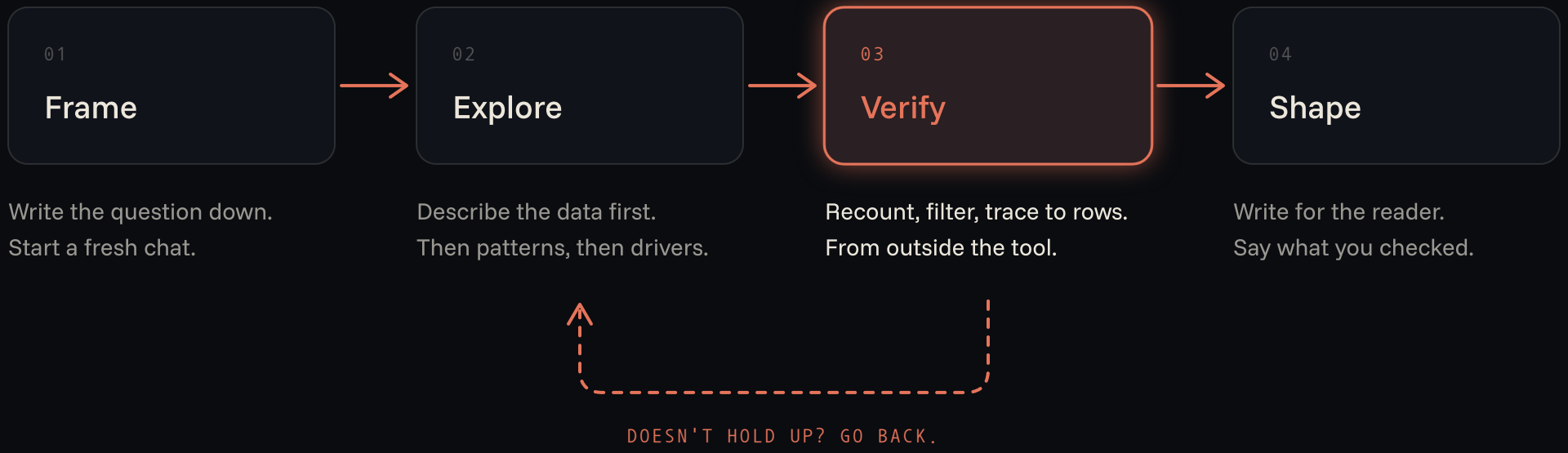
```
NAME Friday status update
USE Raw notes to steering committee
PROMPT You are a project manager... Context: [paste
notes]... Format: RAG status, wins, risks table,
next week. Under 250 words.
CHECK Verify before you ship: every date and
figure.
```

OUTPUT Your prompt library: three prompts you'll reuse this month.

SESSION 3 · CHECK · TOOL 3

Fast analysis. Slow trust.

The check loop. Most of the value is in step three.



TOOL 3 · THE CHECK LOOP

Five ways a smooth answer goes wrong.

01

Miscounts

Especially after filtering or grouping.

02

Correlation sold as cause

"Sunday tickets are slower, so Sundays cause complaints."

03

Silent gaps

Skips missing or messy rows without saying so.

04

Numbers that can't all be true

Shares that add to 112%. An average above the maximum.

05

Invented detail

A data point, quote or source that isn't in the file.

THE FIX

"Are you sure?" doesn't count.

Recount it. Filter it yourself. Trace it to the rows. Then trust it.

EXERCISE 5 · 30 MIN · SOLO OR PAIRS

Karen needs answers by Monday.

01 Frame. Write Karen's three questions down. Start a fresh chat.

02 Explore. Upload the CSV and ask it to describe the data first.

Rows, columns, date range. Does it match what you were told?

03 Verify two numbers yourself.

A spreadsheet filter or a recount. Not "are you sure?"

04 Shape a brief for Karen, under 300 words.

End it with one line: What I checked.

FROM KAREN, CUSTOMER SERVICE MANAGER, RETAILFLOW

1. What are the top three drivers of customer dissatisfaction?

2. When do our response times blow out?

3. What should I do about it?

retailflow-customer-service-data.csv
260 tickets · July to December 2024 · on the course site

OUTPUT A brief Karen could act on Monday.

EXERCISE 6 · 15 MIN · PAIRS, THEN CARD VOTE

Three claims. At least one is wrong.

CLAIM A

"Email is roughly three times slower than Live Chat."

CLAIM B

"Account Issues has the lowest satisfaction of any category, which makes sense, because account problems are the most complex to resolve."

CLAIM C

"Sunday response times are more than double the overall average."

Check against the data, not the confidence. Then vote with your cards.

VERIFIED · OVERSTATED · REFUTED

SESSION 4 · TOOL 4 · OPPORTUNITY FINDER · 1 SPOT

Four signals in your week.

AUTOMATE

You do it often, the same way.

Status reports. Sorting requests. Reformatting.

ASSIST

You read, gather and compare.

Vendor proposals. Meeting prep. Long documents.

GENERATE

You write from a blank page.

Client emails. Job ads. First drafts.

ANALYSE

You hunt for meaning in numbers.

Monthly KPIs. Survey comments. Budget variance.

Start with the task you do every week that bores you most.

TOOL 4 · OPPORTUNITY FINDER · 2 ASSIGN

Decide who leads each step.

AI LEADS

AI drafts it. You review and approve.

Minutes from your notes.

AI ASSISTS

You steer. AI does much of the work.

A client proposal.

YOU LEAD

You do the thinking. AI takes sub-tasks.

A strategy paper.

HUMAN ONLY

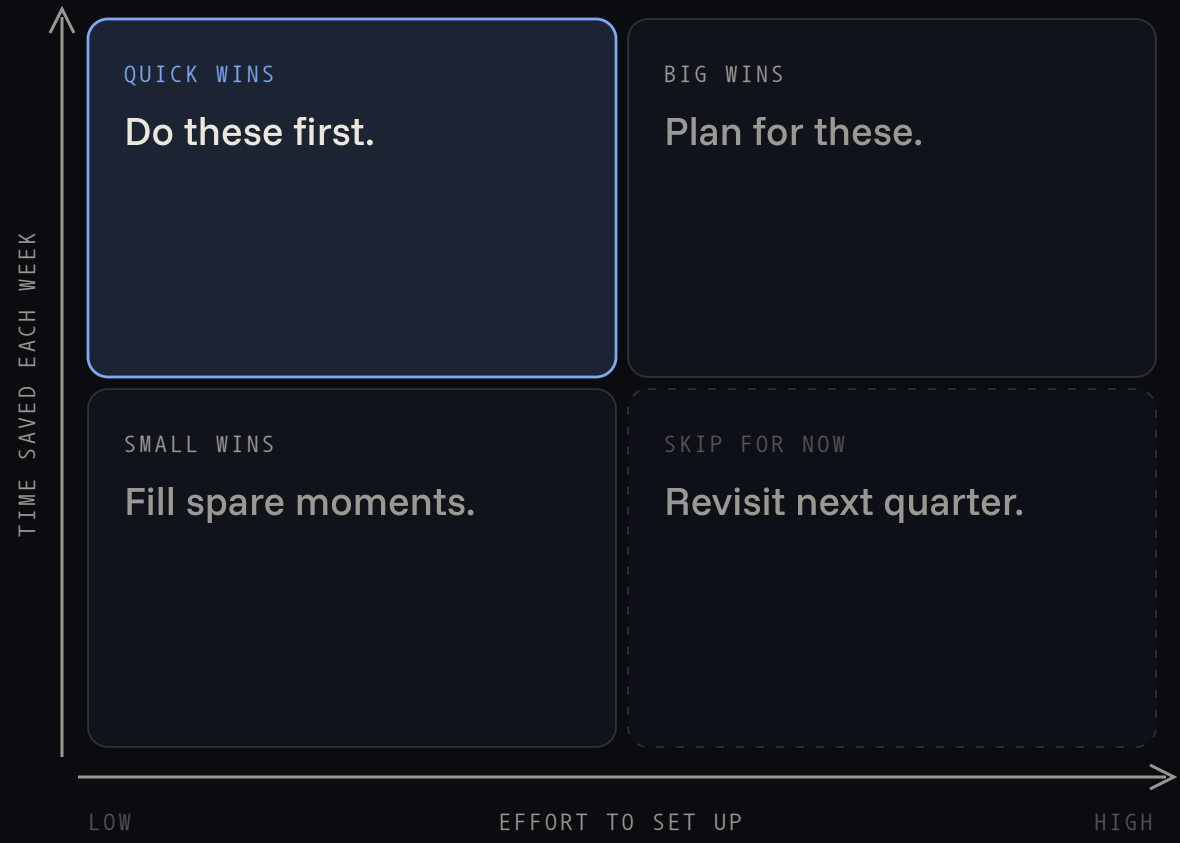
Empathy, ethics, accountability.

Telling someone their role is going.

Then the trust tool sets how hard you check each step.

TOOL 4 · OPPORTUNITY FINDER · 3 PRIORITISE

Start with the quick wins.



A SHORTCUT

Quick wins usually sit in the trust tool's green corner.

Cheap to check, so the time saved is real.

Big wins need a redesigned workflow. That's next.

EXERCISE 7 · 30 MIN · SOLO, THEN TABLES

Redesign one real workflow.

01 Map a task you do weekly that takes 30 minutes or more.

Five to eight steps, with honest minutes for each.

02 Assign each step: signal, who leads, trust corner.

03 Test one AI step live, with an RTCF brief.

Use a saved prompt if one fits.

04 Share one before and after with your table.

One minute each.

EXAMPLE · WEEKLY TEAM UPDATE

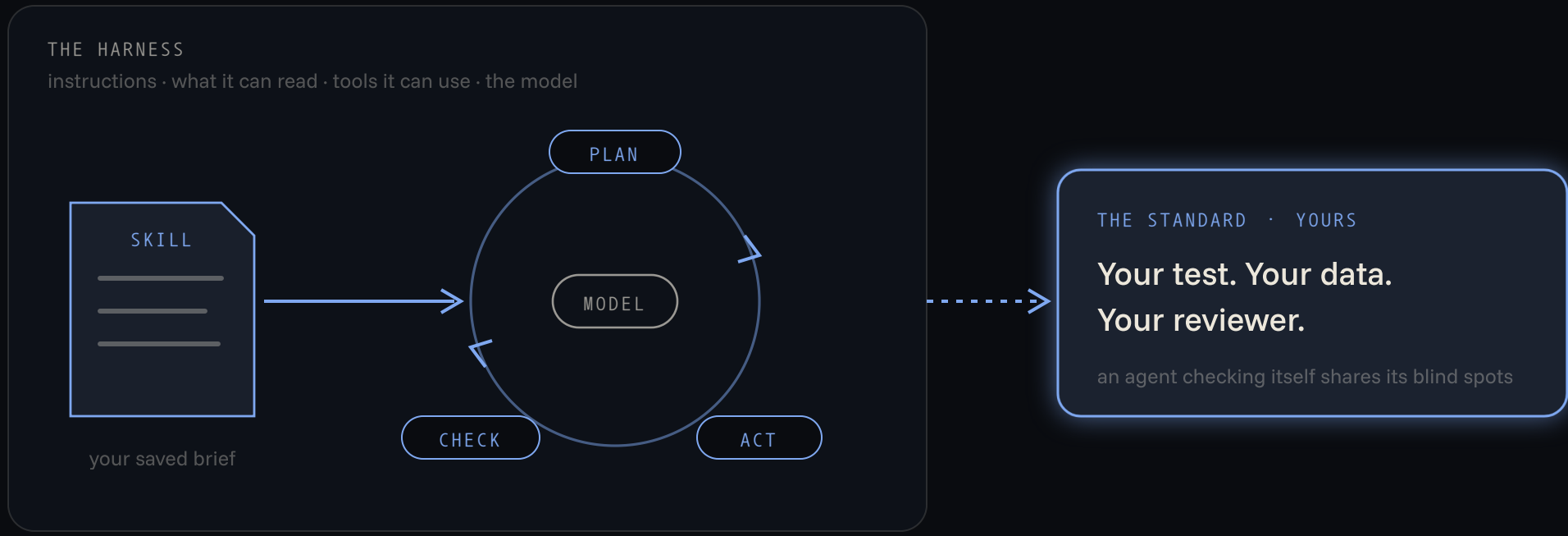
STEP	MIN	WHO LEADS	CHECK
Gather updates	15	You lead	–
Draft the summary	20	AI leads	Light review
Calculate metrics	15	You lead	Before you ship
Send to sponsor	5	Human only	–

Before 55 min · After 30 min

OUTPUT A redesigned workflow you'll run this month.

BEYOND CHAT

Agents run the loop. You set the standard.



Your prompt library is the first draft of a skill.

WHY PRACTICE MATTERS NOW

The bottom rungs are getting thinner.

19%

BELOW TREND

Employment of 22 to 25 year olds in AI-exposed jobs, compared with peers in less-exposed jobs. US payroll data to June 2026.

No comparable gap for experienced workers.

Mostly fewer hires, not more layoffs.

No sign of economy-wide job loss.

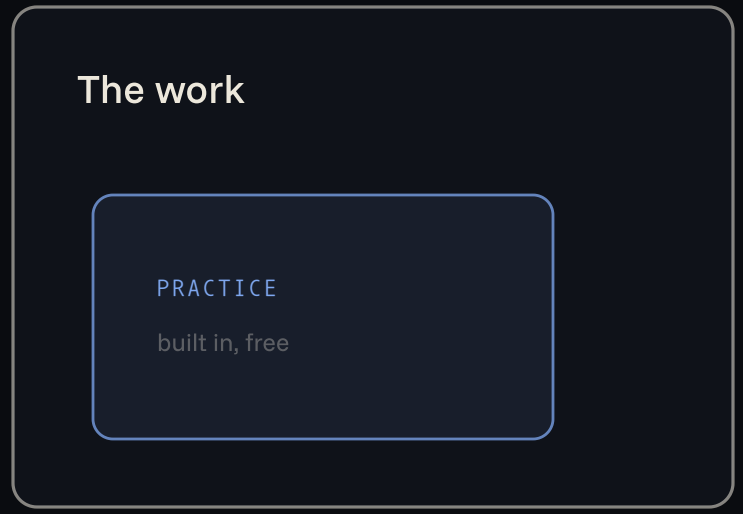
Brynjolfsson, Chandar & Chen, "Canaries in the Coal Mine?", Stanford Digital Economy Lab, revised August 2026.

THE ONE IDEA

Work stopped training you for free.

The grunt work was the tuition. Practice is now something you choose.

FOR A HUNDRED YEARS



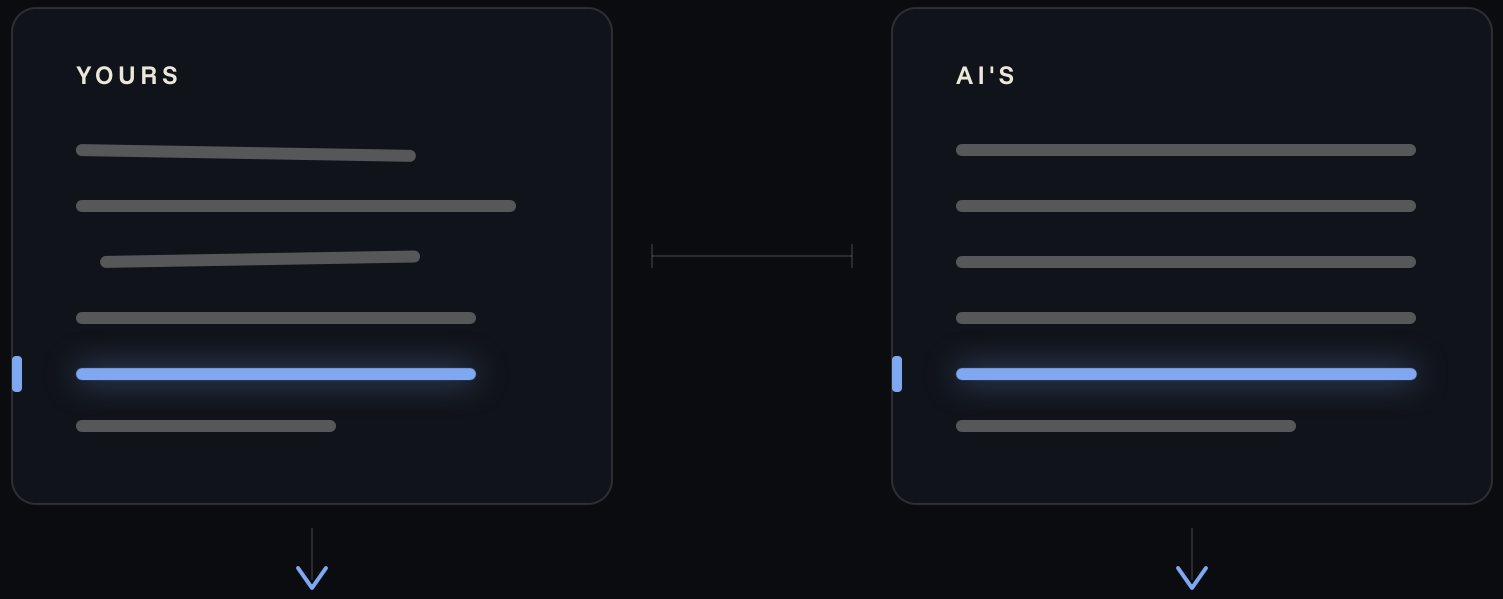
NOW



PRACTISE · THE COMPARE HABIT

Every gap teaches.

One task that matters. Your rough pass first, then AI's. Half an hour.



You caught what it missed

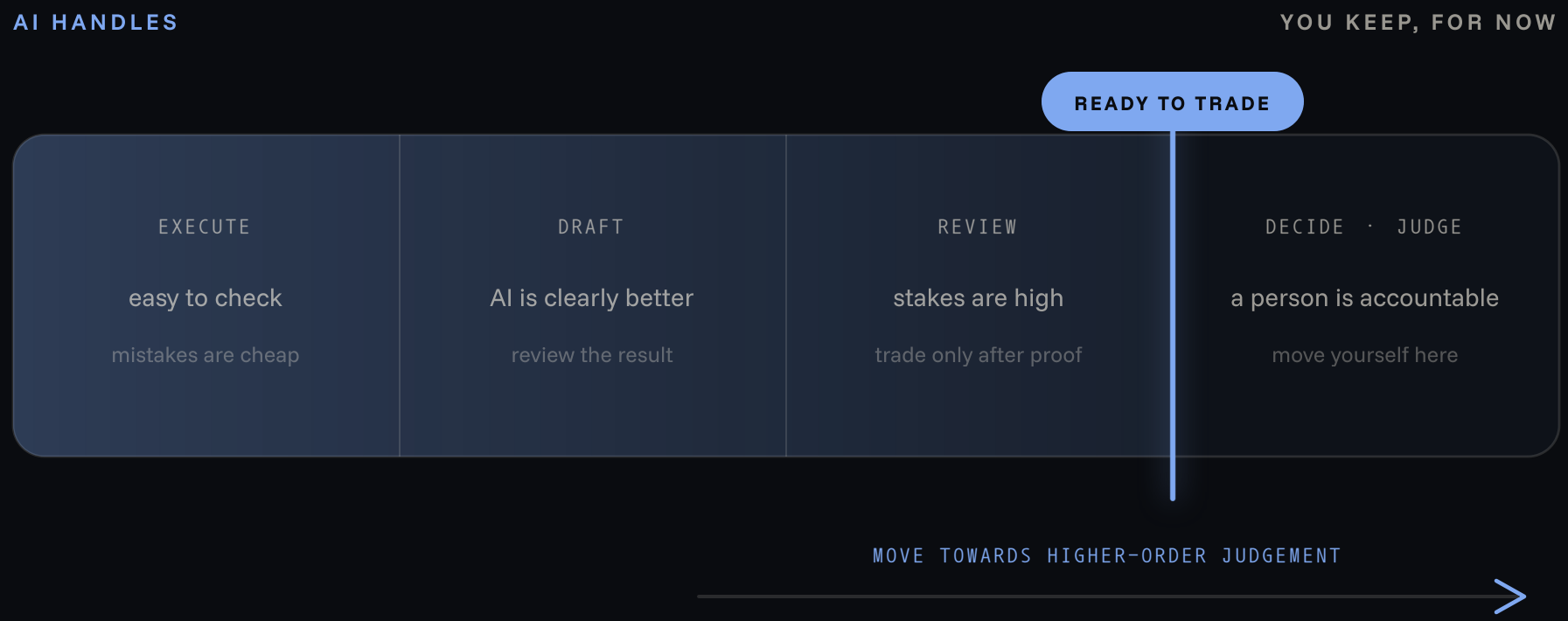
ITS LIMIT

It caught what you missed

YOUR WEAK SPOT

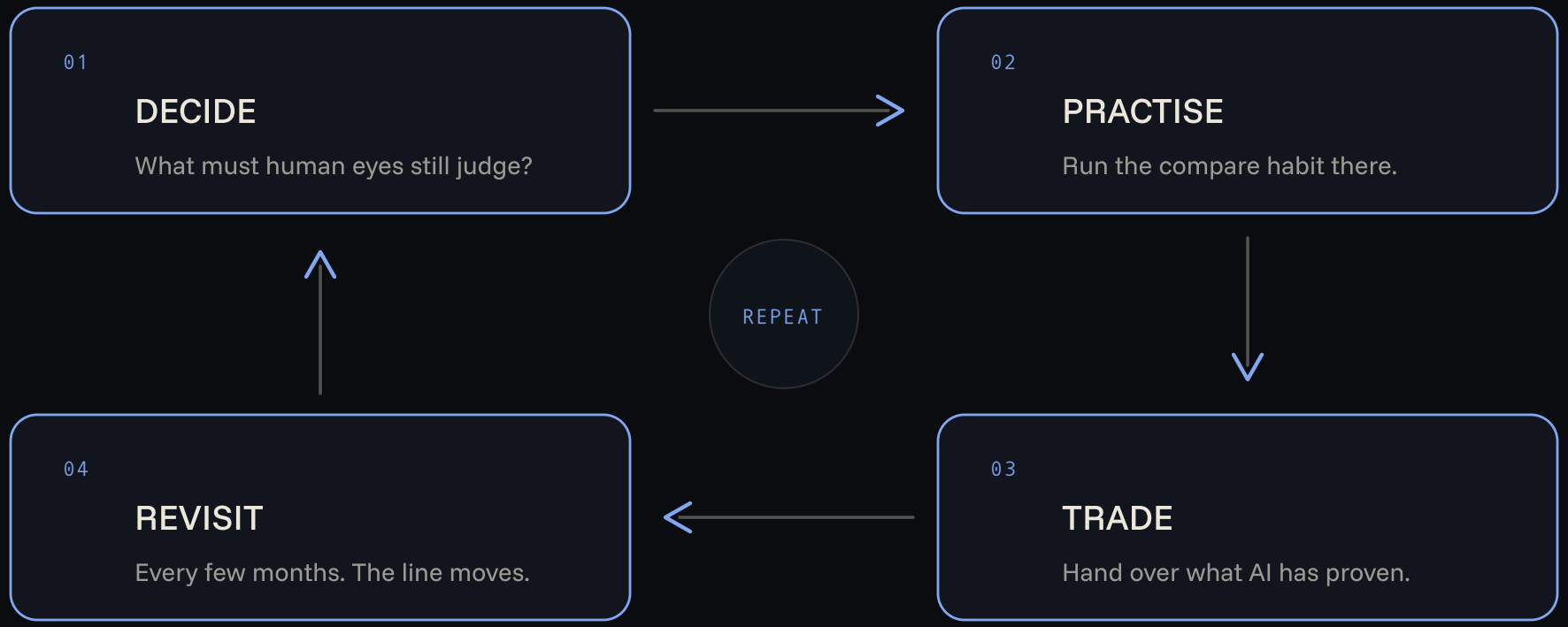
TRADE · ON PURPOSE

The line keeps moving.



YOUR LOOP

Decide. Practise. Trade. Revisit.



IF YOU LEAD PEOPLE

Your juniors lost the easy reps.

Say the reasoning out loud.

When you fix their work, explain why the standard is the standard. They used to absorb that through repetition.

Run side-by-side drills.

By hand first, then with AI, then compare. A scrimmage, not the game.

Choose what stays human.

Decide which fundamentals your team keeps practising on purpose. Revisit as the tools improve.

The focus of **AI in leadership and project management**, course 3 in this series.

EXERCISE 8 · 12 MIN · QUIET, THEN SHARE

Your action plan. One line each.

THIS WEEK · PRACTISE

One compare habit on a task that matters.

Use one saved prompt for real.

THIS MONTH · TRADE

Run your redesigned workflow.

Hand over the steps AI has proven.

THIS QUARTER · DECIDE, REVISIT

Name what must stay human in your role.

Then check whether the line has moved.

EXAMPLE Thursday 9am: draft the steering committee update with my saved prompt, then compare it with my own.

Specific task, tool and day. **Put this week's line in your calendar before you leave.**

THANK YOU

Start small. Check from outside. Repeat.

THE AI CAPABILITY SERIES

1 · TODAY
AI for professionals · How do I use AI well in my role?

2
AI to drive business innovation · Which AI project should we fund?

3
AI in leadership and project management · How do I deliver it?

EVERYTHING FROM TODAY

michael.borck@curtin.edu.au